

Five-page proof skeleton

Maximally Collective Stable Turing Patterns

1. Reaction algebra and topology-wide localization

Construct Y_m and Γ_m directly from the indexed reactions. Reaction-by-reaction verification gives $c^T \Gamma_m = 0$ for $c = (0, 4, \dots, 4, 2, 1)^T$. An explicit $m \times m$ minor proves $\text{rank } \Gamma_m = m$, while solving the balance equations yields

$$\ker \Gamma_m = \text{span}\{(\mathbf{1}_m, 0, 0), (0_m, 1, 1)\}.$$

Therefore every positive flux is $(a\mathbf{1}_m, b, b)$. Differentiation at the unit equilibrium gives $A_m(a, b)$; at a general equilibrium $x^* = H^{-1}\mathbf{1}$, the Jacobian is $A_m(a, b)H$. Conversely $k_r = v_r/(x^*)^{y_r}$ realizes every $a, b, H > 0$.

For a principal set with fewer than m vertices, Frobenius decomposition reduces every nontrivial SCC to: the $X_1, \dots, X_{m-1}$ long cycle; the $X_2, \dots, X_m$ long cycle; a principal boundary-triad block; or a negative singleton. At $b = 2a$ one directed edge disappears and only refines the decomposition. The two cycle characteristic equations are excluded from $\Re \lambda \geq 0$ by strict product inequalities. The full triad has positive cubic coefficients and $c_1 c_2 - c_3$ is a sum of fourteen positive monomials. Every lower-order principal matrix is thus Hurwitz. Sparse expansion of the $X_1, \dots, X_m$ block gives the negative signed determinant $-2a^{m-1}b \prod h_i$, forcing a positive real eigenvalue.

Audit object. Independently generate every induced SCC for $m = 3, \dots, 8$ at generic b and at $b = 2a$, while the proof uses the all- m graph classification rather than enumeration.

2. One-bad-minor theorem and exact diffusion law

For $a_I = (-1)^{|I|} \det J_{I,I}$ and $D \succ 0$, multilinearity gives

$$\det(sD - J) = \sum_I a_I \prod_{j \notin I} s d_j = s(\beta_1 + \beta_2 s + \cdots + \beta_n s^{n-1}).$$

Every a_I with $|I| \leq n - 2$ is positive because $J_{I,I}$ is Hurwitz, so $\beta_k > 0$ for $k \geq 2$. The bracket is strictly increasing on $s > 0$, proving the unique simple threshold iff $\beta_1 < 0$.

For the stronger positive-real band, define

$$\chi_s(\lambda) = \det(\lambda I + sD - J) = \sum_I a_I \prod_{j \notin I} (\lambda + s d_j).$$

Every derivative contribution from $|I| \leq n - 2$ is nonnegative. The total order- $(n - 1)$ derivative is $\sum_{|I|=n-1} a_I$, the coefficient of λ in $\det(\lambda I - J)$, which is positive because the nonzero spectrum is stable and the zero is simple. Hence $\chi'_s(\lambda) > 0$ for $\lambda \geq 0$. The sign of $\chi_s(0)$ therefore gives a positive real eigenvalue exactly for $0 < s < s_*$.

For $A_m(a, b)H$, compute every order- m omission minor. Omitting Z gives weight -2 ; omitting an interior X_j gives $+16$; omitting X_1 or X_m gives zero. Thus

$$\beta_1 = 2a^{m-1}b \prod_{i=1}^m h_i \left(8h_Z \sum_{j=2}^{m-1} \frac{d_j}{h_j} - d_Z \right).$$

This proves the exact criterion. The same sign follows from first-order perturbation of the conservation eigenvalue. For fixed H , minimizing $d_{\max}/d_{\min}$ under the strict inequality gives the nonattained infimum $T(H) = 8h_Z \sum h_j^{-1}$. At $H = I$, $T = 8(m - 2)$, and $h_Z/h_j \geq 1/\chi_H$ gives $\chi_D \chi_H > 8(m - 2)$.

3. Improved unit-equilibrium primary bifurcation

Set $a = b = 1$, $H = I$, $K_i = 91m - 181 - i$, and use

$$d_1 = 23/63, \quad d_i = K_i^{-1}, \quad d_m = 1/7, \quad d_Z = 16/45.$$

An explicit right vector satisfies $(A_m - D_m)r = 0$ and an explicit left vector satisfies $(A_m - D_m)^T \ell = 0$. Exact harmonic-sum formulas prove $\ell^T r < 0$ and $\ell^T D_m r < 0$, hence transversality $\eta_m > 0$.

Homogeneous stability follows from

$$\det(\lambda I - A_m) = \lambda q_m(\lambda), \quad \lambda q_m = (1 + \lambda)^{m-3} P(\lambda) - R(\lambda),$$

where $P = \lambda^4 + 12\lambda^3 + 42\lambda^2 + 47\lambda + 16$ and $R = 5\lambda^2 + 33\lambda + 16$. The exact difference $|1 + \lambda|^2 |P|^2 - |R|^2$ expands into 35 nonnegative monomials in $x = \Re \lambda$ and $y^2 = (\Im \lambda)^2$, with equality only at the origin.

For spatial damping tD_m , chain elimination gives $\det(\lambda I - A_m + tD_m) = Q_m F - G$. At $t = 1$, the interior product telescopes to 91/90. Retaining one exact factor yields a 77-term nonnegative boundary difference in $(x, y^2, t - 1)$, strict except at $(0, 0, 0)$. Hence the first mode has one simple zero, all other first-mode eigenvalues are stable, and all $t > 1$ modes are Hurwitz.

The exact unit contrast is

$$\chi_D = \frac{23(91m - 183)}{63},$$

which improves the superseded coefficient-1589 profile and is within a dimension-independent factor of the sharp linear threshold.

4. Conservation-compatible normal form and stable branch

The mass-action field is quadratic:

$$f(\mathbf{1} + u) = A_m u + \frac{1}{2} B_m(u, u), \quad c^T B_m(u, v) = 0.$$

On the fixed integrated-mass class, the critical mode is $r \cos \xi$. Since $\cos^2 \xi = (1 + \cos 2\xi)/2$, solve

$$A_m w_0 = -\frac{1}{4} B(r, r), \quad c^T w_0 = 0, \quad (A_m - 4D_m) w_2 = -\frac{1}{4} B(r, r).$$

The first is an augmented nonsingular solve; the second is invertible by mode isolation. The interior w_2 recurrence telescopes through four consecutive K_i factors, leaving an explicit 3×3 boundary system.

Projection onto the adjoint critical mode yields

$$\dot{A} = \eta_m \mu A + c_m A^3 + O(|A|^5 + |A|^3 |\mu| + |A| |\mu|^2),$$

$$c_m = \frac{\ell^T \{B(r, w_0) + \frac{1}{2} B(r, w_2)\}}{\ell^T r}.$$

The numerator telescopes to $R_m + C_m \mathcal{H}_m$. A rational upper bound on $\mathcal{H}_m$ and shifted coefficientwise-positive polynomials prove the numerator positive, while $\ell^T r < 0$; therefore $c_m < 0$ for every $m \geq 3$.

Crandall–Rabinowitz gives two positive branches for $\mu > 0$. Their center eigenvalue is $-2\eta_m \mu + O(\mu^2) < 0$. The complementary spectrum is separated at onset and remains separated under analytic perturbation. Positive Neumann diffusion is sectorial on fixed-mass L^2 , its fractional H^1 domain is a Banach algebra in one dimension, and the quadratic Nemytskii map is smooth. The principle of linearized stability gives local exponential convergence in H^1 for sufficiently close nonnegative initial data in the same conservation class.

5. Equilibrium-scaled stable trade-off and audit boundaries

Let $r = m - 2$, $L_0 = (3r)^{-1/2}$, $L_1 = 90r/(90r + 1)$, set $h_1 = h_m = h_Z = 1$, $h_i = K_i/(LK_{i-1})$, and choose physical diffusion $D^{\text{phys}} = H\Delta$. Under $z = Hx$,

$$z_t = H\{f(z) + \Delta z_{xx}\}.$$

The effective critical bracket and right vector are unchanged; the dynamic left vector is $H^{-1}\ell$. The physical fixed-mass functional is $(H^{-1}c)^T z$.

Chain elimination now gives interior factors

$$g_i = \frac{K_{i-1}}{K_i}(1 + L\lambda) + \frac{t-1}{K_i}.$$

The bounds $rL^2 \geq 1/3$ and Bernoulli's inequality reduce homogeneous and spatial half-plane exclusion to 34- and 84-term nonnegative certificates. The second harmonic is unchanged, while the zero harmonic changes by $w_0(L) = w_0^{\text{ref}} + \tau_m(L)\rho$. The cubic numerator is $N_m(L) = N_m^{\text{ref}} + \tau_m(L)S_m$. Exact bounds

$$N_m^{\text{ref}} > 1/100, \quad -1/10 < S_m < 0, \quad \tau_m(L) < 1/20$$

give $N_m(L) > 1/200$, hence $c_m(L) < 0$ throughout the certified interval.

The physical contrasts are

$$\chi_D = \frac{23}{63}91rL, \quad \chi_H = \frac{91r-1}{91rL}.$$

At L_0 , both are $\Theta(\sqrt{m})$. The universal product lower bound implies any simultaneous control must have $\max(\chi_D, \chi_H) > \sqrt{8r}$, so exponent $1/2$ is optimal. Constants remain open.

External failure tests. Verify the SCC exhaustion at $b = 2a$; the one-bad-minor derivative argument; all certificate equality cases; the transformed physical diffusion; the fixed-mass gauge; and the comparison $N_m(L) > 1/200$. No finite regression substitutes for these all- m identities.